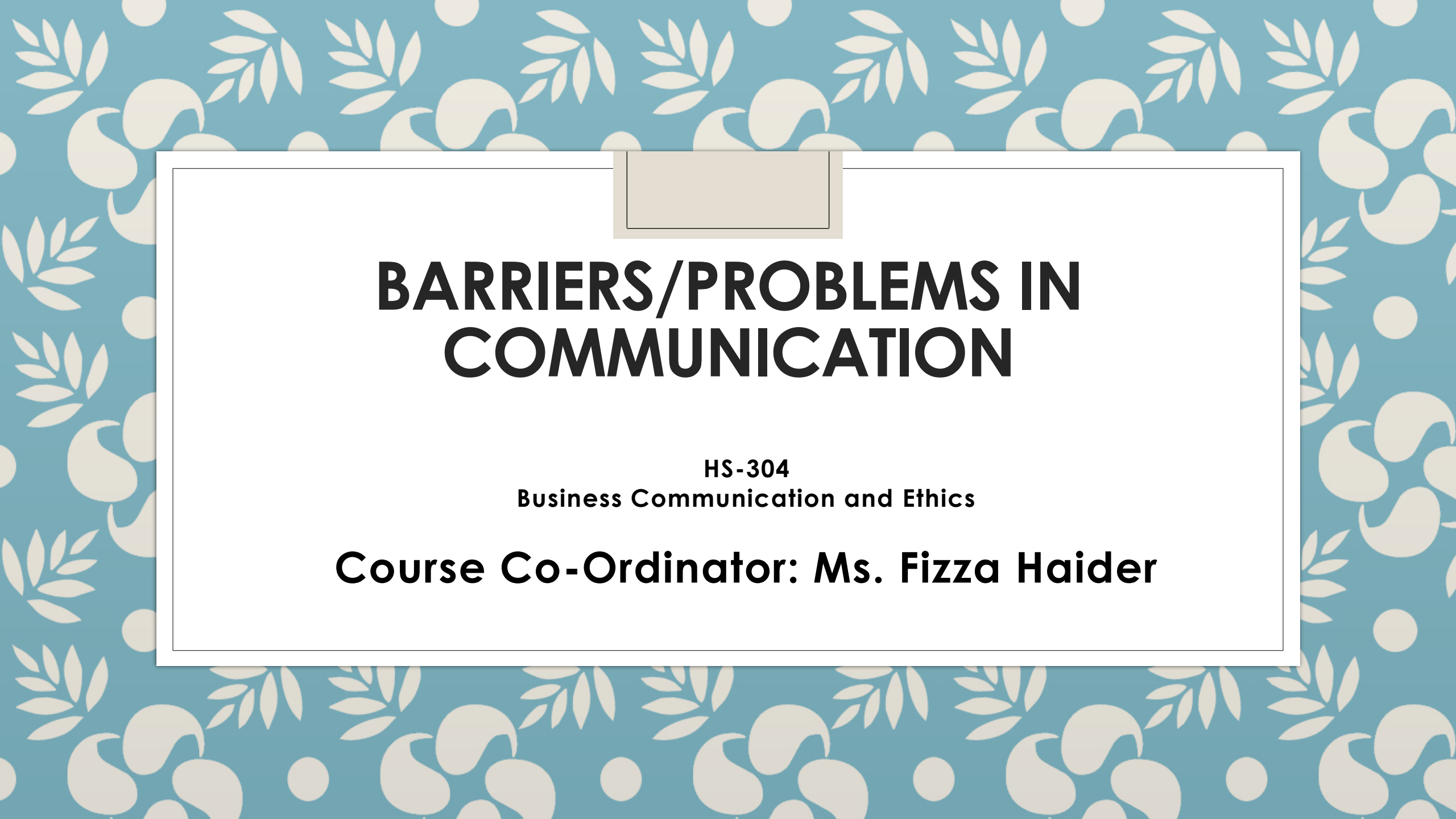




BARRIERS/PROBLEMS IN COMMUNICATION

HS-304

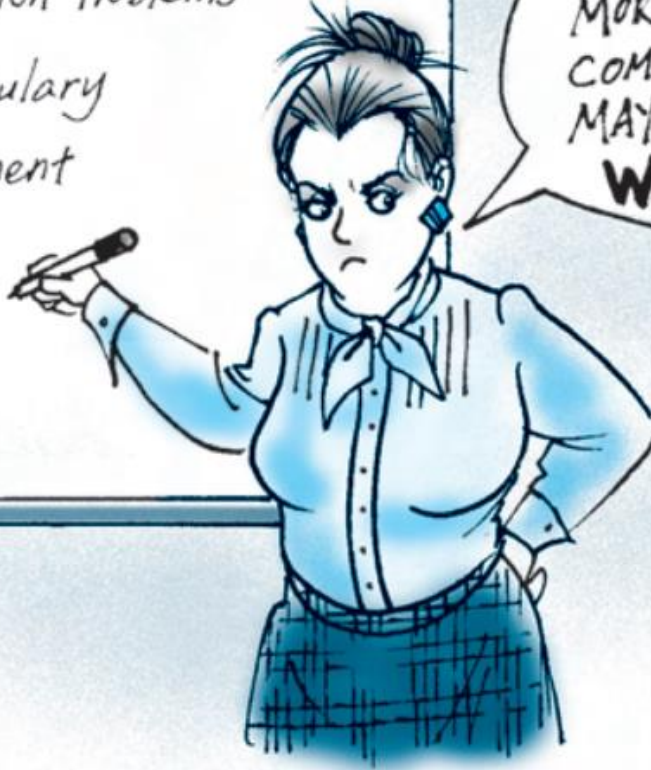
Business Communication and Ethics

Course Co-Ordinator: Ms. Fizza Haider

Communication Problems

1. Poor Vocabulary
2. Pre-Judgment
3. Lack of

CAN YOU THINK OF
MORE REASONS WHY
COMMUNICATION
MAY FAIL?
WAKE UP John!



What are Communication Barriers?

- **'factors that can distort or prevent communication within an organization'**
- 1. Physical barriers
- 2. Perceptual barriers
- 3. Emotional barriers
- 4. Cultural barriers
- 5. Language barriers
- 6. Gender barriers



Types of Communication Barriers

- 1.Noise and distractions
- 2.Competing Messages
- 3.Channel Breakdowns
- 4.Bypassing
- 5.Differing Frames of reference
- 6.Lack of language skills



1.Noise and distractions

- • **‘Noise’** – one of the **external distractions**
- e.g. crowded rooms or computer screens
- • **‘Thoughts and emotions’** – **internal distractions**
- e.g. A worried man lacks focus
- • **‘Multitasking’** – attempting more than one task at a time – is a recipe for **distractions**
- e.g. juggling between different tasks isn’t always a good idea.



1. Noise

- Noise **refers to distraction and interference in the environment** in which communication takes place. This affects the **accuracy, clarity or even the arrival of the message.**
- **Types of Noise:**
 - i. **Physical Noise**
 - ii. **Technical Noise**
 - iii. **Social Noise**
 - iv. **Psychological Noise**



1. Noise

i. Physical Noise:

Obstruction caused by environmental factors is termed as physical noise.

This may include noise of **other people talking, passing traffic**, etc.

This may prevent a message from being heard clearly.



1. Noise

ii. Technical Noise:

This involves in the **failure of the medium of communication.**

It includes **crackle on the telephone line** or **illegible handwriting**, **problem in the microphone**, **bad throat**, **shrill voice**, **blurred image** due to the ineffective projection by Over Head or multimedia projector.

This may prevent the exchange of information.



1. Noise

iii. Social Noise

It is the interference **caused by differences in personality and cultures of the members communicating.**

It includes difficulties faced by people who have **differences in ages, castes, social status, gender, education, religion, language, life styles etc.**



1. Noise

iv. Psychological Noise

It includes **factors such as excessive emotion, prejudice, nervousness etc.**

How the receiver feels at the time of receiving communication message will influence how he or she interprets it.

The same message received when you are angry is often interpreted differently when you are happy.

Extreme emotions, such as **depression are most likely to hinder effective communication.** Your **mood, emotional status, mindsets** all effect communication logical approach in the argument.

A person who is too **emotional** may not understand the logical approach in the argument. A person who has lost temper may not understand a very logical and sensible idea.

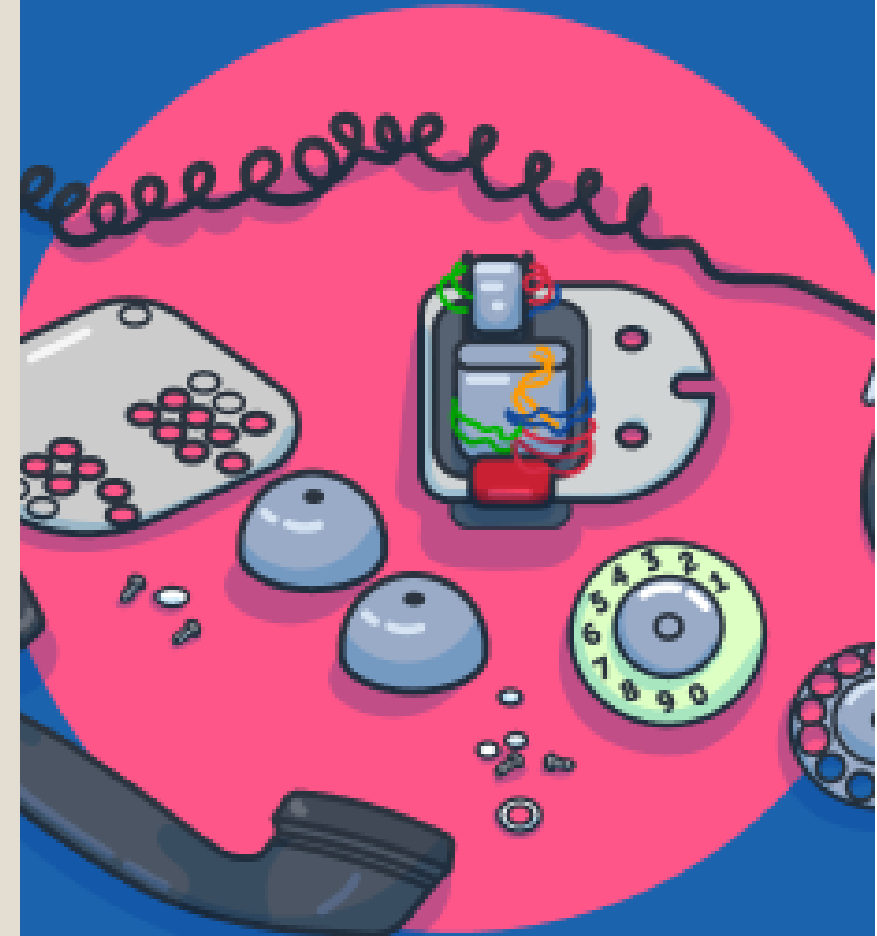
2. COMPETING MESSAGES

- • Caused by **‘information overload’** – that makes it **difficult for the receiver** of your message **to discriminate between useful and useless messages**
- • Your audiences are likely to get messages from other sources also
- • In that case, **your message competes with the other messages, trying to reach your audience.**

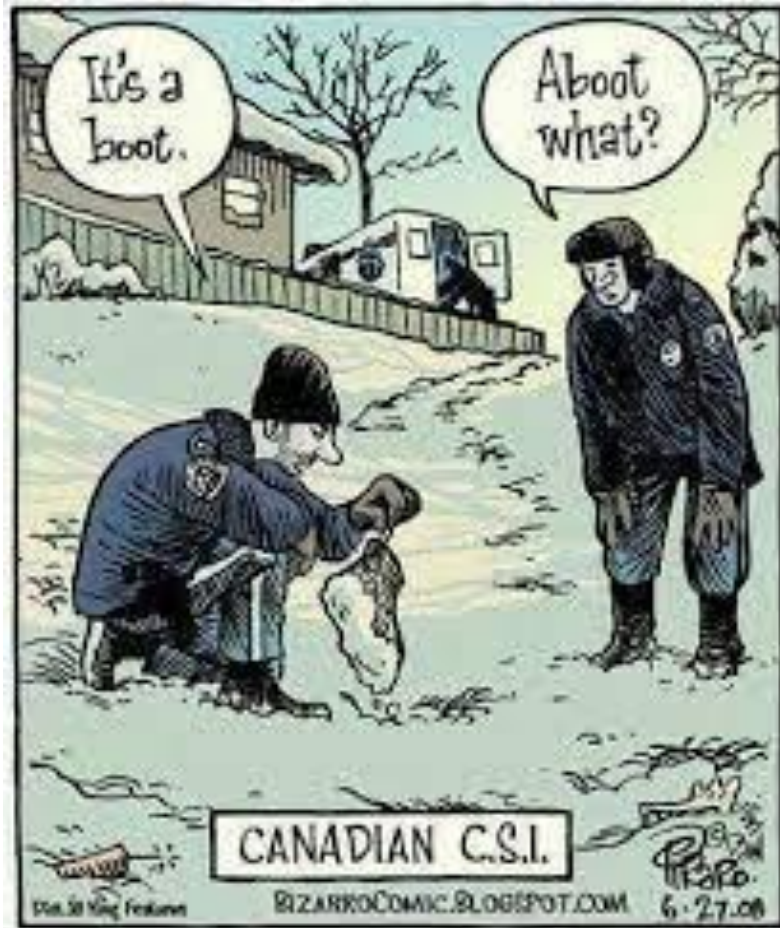


3. CHANNEL BREAKDOWNS

- • This happens **when the channel fails to deliver your message.**
- e.g. **a lost mail, crashing of computer server, weak internet connection, distortion in the phone line.**



4. BYPASSING



- • It is one of the **biggest barriers that involves words**
- • **Meanings are not always contained in words. Sometimes, it's we who assign our own unique meanings to different words.**
- • Bypassing happens **when people miss each other with their meanings.**
- • For **successful communication**, sender and receiver **must attach the same meanings to different words.**

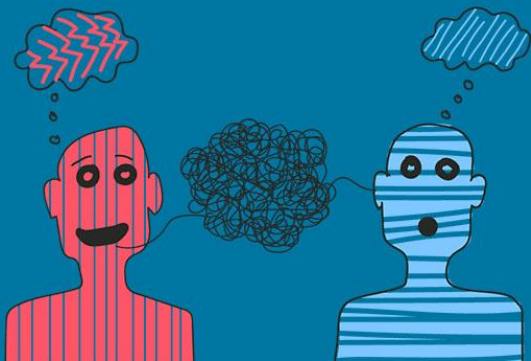
5. DIFFERENT FRAMES OF REFERENCE

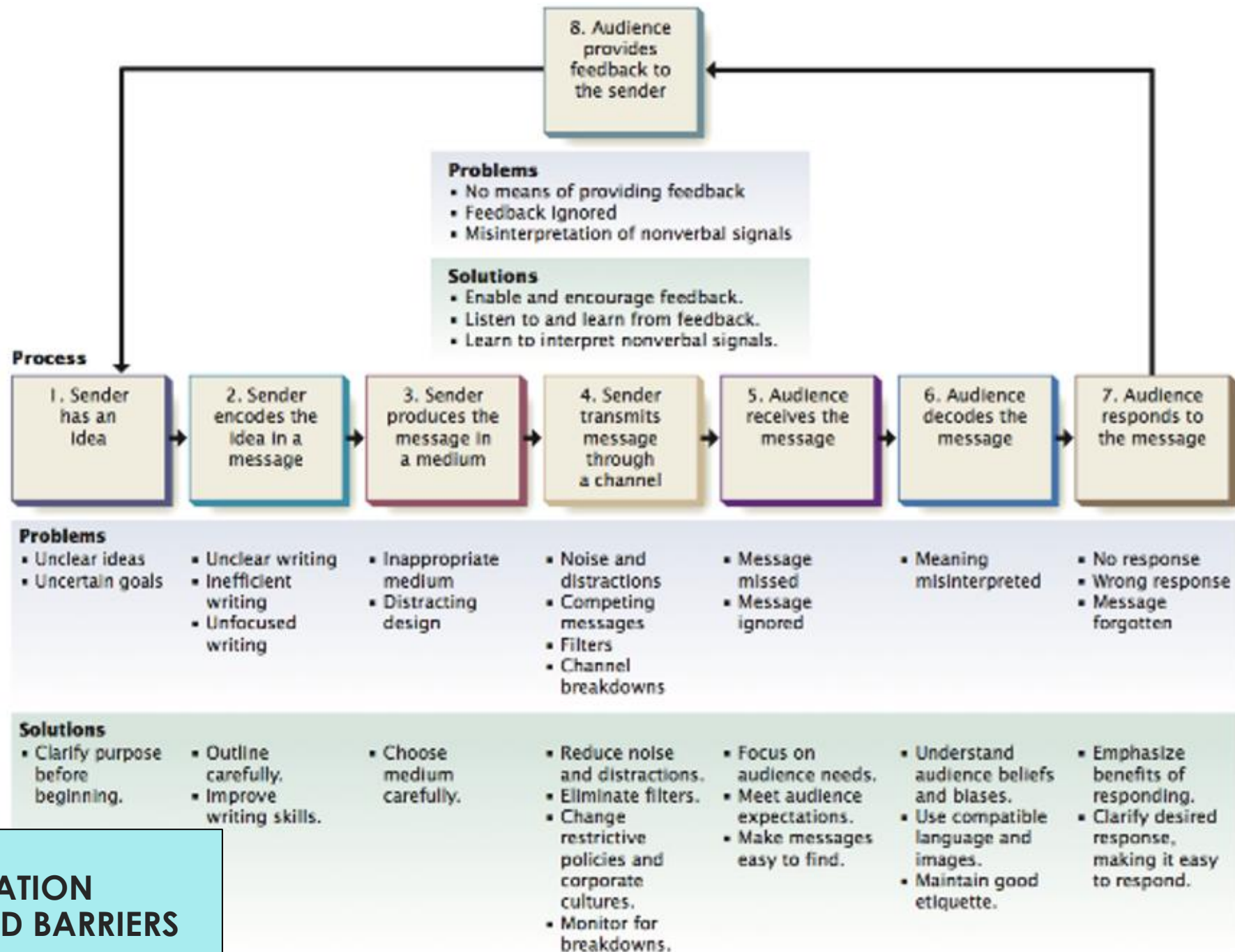
- • Our **unique frame is formed** by a combination of our **experiences, education, culture, expectations, personality, and other elements.**
- As a result, we bring our **own biases and expectations** to any communication situation.
- Because our frame of reference is different from everyone else's, **we will never see things exactly as others do**



6. LACK OF LANGUAGE SKILLS

- Language skills imply
 - • **Adequate vocabulary**
 - • **Command of basic pronunciation and grammar**
 - • **Skill in written and oral expression**
 - • **Active listening skills**





COMMUNICATION PROCESS AND BARRIERS

CLASS ACTIVITY # 1

- Look around and list any ten barriers that you believe are affecting the process of communication.

